



Facebook & Instagram

Messaging Bot Setup Guide

Step-by-step integration with the Mana AI Hub

PLATFORM

Meta (Facebook)

CHANNELS

Messenger + Instagram DM

EFFORT

~2–4 hours + review

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1. What to Collect from the Client

Before any technical work begins, gather the following from the client. This is everything needed to connect their Facebook Page and Instagram account to the bot.

Facebook Page

- Client must have an existing Facebook Page (not a personal profile).
- You need Admin access to the Page — ask the client to go to:
Facebook Page !' Settings !' Page Roles !' Add you as Admin.
- Note down the Facebook Page ID:
Page Settings !' About !' scroll to bottom !' Page ID.

Instagram Account

- Instagram account must be a Business or Creator account (not Personal).
- It must be connected to the Facebook Page:
Instagram app !' Settings !' Account !' Linked Accounts !' Facebook.
- If not yet converted: Instagram !' Settings !' Account !' Switch to Professional Account.

Meta Business Suite

- The client should have a Meta Business Suite (business.facebook.com) account.
- Ask them to add you as a Partner:
Business Settings !' Partners !' Add !' enter your Business ID or email.
- Alternative: they can give you temporary admin access to their Facebook account to set up the app and revoke it afterward.

& If the client does not have a Meta Business account, help them create one first at business.facebook.com — it is free and required for production API access.

Checklist Summary

- ☐ **Facebook Page** — Admin access granted to your account
- ☐ **Facebook Page ID** — Noted from Page Settings !' About
- ☐ **Instagram account** — Business/Creator type
- ☐ **Instagram !' Facebook** — Linked in Instagram settings
- ☐ **Meta Business Suite** — Partner access granted

2. Create a Meta Developer App

This app is the bridge between the bot server and the client's Facebook/Instagram accounts. It lives in the Meta Developer Portal.

1 Go to the Meta Developer Portal

Visit developers.facebook.com and log in with the client's Facebook account (or your own if you have partner access).

2 Create a New App

Click "My Apps" ! "Create App". Choose "Business" as the app type. Give it a name like "Mana AI Hub" and link it to the client's Meta Business account.

3 Add the Messenger Product

On the App Dashboard, click "Add Product" ! find "Messenger" ! click "Set Up".

4 Add the Instagram Product

Still on the App Dashboard ! "Add Product" ! find "Instagram" (Instagram Graph API) ! click "Set Up".

5 Note the App Credentials

Go to App Settings ! Basic. Copy the App ID and App Secret — you'll need these as environment variables.

⚠ Keep the App Secret confidential — treat it like a password. Never commit it to git.

3. Configure Messenger API

1 Connect the Facebook Page

In Messenger settings ! "Access Tokens" ! click "Add or Remove Pages" ! select the client's Facebook Page ! grant all requested permissions.

2 Generate a Page Access Token

After connecting, click "Generate Token" next to the Page name. Copy this — it's the `FACEBOOK_PAGE_ACCESS_TOKEN`.

3 Make the Token Permanent

The generated token is short-lived by default. To make it never-expiring:

1. Exchange it for a long-lived token using the Graph API Explorer
2. Or use the "Generate Token" button with the correct permissions (`pages_messaging`, `pages_read_engagement`) — this produces a permanent token automatically when the app is Live.

& In Development mode, the bot can only send messages to users who are listed as App Testers or Admins. You must go Live (Section 7) to reach real customers.

4. Configure Instagram Messaging API

1 Link Instagram in the Instagram Product Settings

In the Instagram product settings ! "Set Up Instagram" ! "Add Account" ! select the client's Instagram Business account.

2 Grant Permissions

Make sure the following permissions are enabled:

- instagram_basic
- instagram_manage_messages
- pages_manage_metadata

3 Access Token

Instagram DMs use the same Page Access Token as Messenger. No separate token is needed, but the token must have instagram_manage_messages scope.

Ø=Ü; To verify the token has Instagram scope, go to Graph API Explorer ! paste the token ! check "Permissions" tab for instagram_manage_messages.

5. Webhook Setup

Webhooks are how Meta sends incoming messages to your server in real time. The server must be publicly accessible (e.g. deployed on Render).

1 Choose a Verify Token

This is any random string you create — e.g. "mana-fb-webhook-2025". Store it as FACEBOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN in your .env file.

2 Configure Webhook in Messenger Settings

Messenger product ! "Webhooks" ! "Add Callback URL"

Callback URL: `https://your-server.com/webhook/facebook`

Verify Token: (the string you chose above)

Subscribe to: messages, messaging_postbacks, messaging_read

3 Subscribe the Page

After saving, click "Add Subscriptions" next to the connected Page and check: messages, messaging_postbacks

4 Configure Webhook for Instagram

Instagram product ! "Webhooks" ! same callback URL ! subscribe to: messages, messaging_postbacks

5 Verify the Webhook

Meta will send a GET request to your webhook URL with hub.verify_token and hub.challenge. The server must respond with hub.challenge to confirm. Once done, Meta shows a green checkmark.

Webhook endpoint the server will expose:

GET /webhook/facebook ! verification handshake

POST /webhook/facebook ! incoming messages (Messenger + Instagram)

6. Environment Variables Reference

Add the following variables to your .env file on the server. Never commit these to git.

```
FACEBOOK_APP_ID=
123456789012345      # From App
FACEBOOK_APP_SECRET=
abc123...           # From App
FACEBOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN=mana-fb-
webhook-2025        # You choose this
FACEBOOK_PAGE_ACCESS_TOKEN=
EAAXxxxxx...        # From
Messenger i' Access Tokens
```

If the client has separate Facebook Pages for Mana Shop and Mana Kendra, use distinct variable names:

```
FACEBOOK_PAGE_ACCESS_TOKEN_MANA_SHOP=
EAAXxxxxx...
FACEBOOK_PAGE_ACCESS_TOKEN_MANA_KENDR
A=EAAXxxxxx...
```

Ø=Üj Instagram DMs share the same Page Access Token as Messenger — no extra variable needed.

7. App Review — Going Live

In Development mode only you (admins/testers) can interact with the bot. To serve real customers, you must submit for App Review.

Permissions to Request

`pages_messaging` — Required to send and receive messages via Messenger
`instagram_manage_messages` — Required to send and receive Instagram DMs
`pages_read_engagement` — Required to read page content for context
`pages_manage_metadata` — Required to subscribe to webhook events

Submission Steps

1 Switch App to Live mode

App Dashboard i' top toggle i' switch from "Development" to "Live". A warning will appear if required permissions aren't approved yet — that's normal at this stage.

2 Go to App Review i' Permissions

Click "Add to Submission" next to each permission listed above. Provide a short description of how the bot uses each one.

3 Record a Screen Video

Meta requires a video showing the bot in action. Record a short demo of a user sending a message and the bot replying. Upload to the submission.

4 Submit

Click Submit for Review. Review typically takes 1–5 business days. Meta may request additional information.

& Do NOT use fake or placeholder data in the review submission. Use the real bot responding to real test messages — Meta reviewers test it themselves.

8. Testing Before Going Live

Run through these tests while still in Development mode. Add yourself and the client as App Testers in App Roles.

Webhook Verification Test

- Check server logs — when you saved the webhook URL, the server should have logged a GET request with `hub.verify_token`.
- Meta Dashboard should show a green checkmark next to the webhook URL.

Messenger Test

- From a personal Facebook account added as an App Tester, send a message to the client's Facebook Page.
- Verify the message appears in server logs (POST `/webhook/facebook`).
- Verify the bot replies within 5 seconds.

Instagram DM Test

- From an Instagram account added as a tester, send a DM to the client's Instagram Business account.
- Verify the reply comes back from the Instagram account.

Human Handoff Test

- Send a message that triggers handoff (e.g. "I want to speak to a human").
- Verify it appears in the Mana AI Hub dashboard marked for human review.

9. Common Issues & Fixes

Webhook returns 403

The `FACEBOOK_VERIFY_TOKEN` in `.env` doesn't match what you entered in Meta Dashboard. Double-check for extra spaces.

Bot not replying in Messenger

The Page Access Token may be expired or missing `pages_messaging` scope. Regenerate the token.

Instagram DMs not received

The Instagram account isn't linked to the Facebook Page, or `instagram_manage_messages` permission is missing.

Messages only go to admins

App is still in Development mode. Switch to Live mode and complete App Review.

Token expires after 1 hour

You used a short-lived token. Exchange it for a long-lived token via Graph API Explorer (60-day) or generate during Live mode (permanent).

"Unsupported get request" error

The webhook URL path doesn't match what the server exposes. Confirm the route is `/webhook/facebook`.

Quick Reference Card

Meta Developer Portal: developers.facebook.com

Meta Business Suite: business.facebook.com

Graph API Explorer: developers.facebook.com/tools/explorer

App Review Status: [developers.facebook.com !' App Review !' Requests](https://developers.facebook.com/docs/app-review)

Webhook Callback URL: <https://your-server.com/webhook/facebook>

Token Debugger: developers.facebook.com/tools/debug/accesstoken

Required Permissions Summary

Permission	Messenger	Instagram
pages_messaging	'	—
instagram_manage_messages	—	'
pages_read_engagement	'	'
pages_manage_metadata	'	'

Ø=Ü; Bookmark the Token Debugger — it shows the exact expiry, scopes, and which Page the token belongs to. Use it any time a token seems to stop working.

